was equal to fifty killed at the other targets.[39] Immediately after breaching the building, Nasir [a.k.a. Abu Omar] from Faisalabad and Imran Babar [a.k.a. Abu Aakasha] from Multan killed Rabbi Gavriel Holtzberg and his wife Rivka, who together managed the Chabad House. The fidayeen also killed two guests. Imran took Rabbi Holtzberg's mobile phone and called an Indian television channel. He claimed credit for the attacks on behalf of the Deccan Mujahideen, a phony group ostensibly comprised of Indian Muslims and concocted to hide Lashkar's involvement.[40] A Lashkar communications specialist also sent an email from Pakistan on behalf of the fictitious group warning the government to 'stop the continuing injustice against the Muslims' and demanding it 'return all the states seized from the Muslims.'[41]

The fidayeen kept two women as hostages, and once news of Kasab's arrest was reported their potential value increased. From a Lashkar command center in Pakistan Sajid Mir directed the terrorists to force one of the women to call the Israeli consulate in the hopes that the Israeli government could secure Kasab's release.[42] She was also made to give a status update directly to Sajid who, speaking in fluent English, promised he would release her and the other hostage in exchange for Kasab. He even suggested she might be free by the beginning of the weekend, in time to 'celebrate your Sabbath with your family.'[43] However, by the night of the second day, it was becoming apparent that India was not about to release Kasab and Lashkar handlers in Pakistan did not want to risk the chance that the hostages might get away should the fidayeen come under attack. The gunmen were ordered to kill the hostages, all of whom were dead by the time Indian forces assaulted the building. The Holtzbergs' maidservant, who managed to hide from the attackers, escaped with the couple's two-year old son.

In total, 166 civilians and security personnel were killed and 304 were injured.[44] The attacks dragged on for almost three days, prolonging Lashkar's moment in the spotlight and embarrassing the Indian security forces. Dividing their forces and moving from target to target had created the impression of a larger strike force, which the fidayeen fed by inflating their numbers in calls to the press. Erroneous media reporting subsequently overestimated the actual size of the fidayeen squad. The one major cost associated with the use of multiple strike teams was that the small size of